HR + IT + Methods Note: Time to Fill Open Positions

1. HR workflow actions

Action | Owner | How we'll know it's working

Use one optional selection round by default (phone screen or technical assessment). Using both needs HR approval when the job is posted. | HR Recruitment Lead and hiring managers | Fewer hires go through both rounds (today 40 of 271, about 15%). Share of hires within 90 days rises above 36.5%.

Start assembling the interview panel while shortlisting, not after. | Hiring managers | Panel assembly averages 5 days or less (today 7.4).

Set a 7-day expectation for reviewing résumés, with an HR reminder on day 5. | Hiring managers, supported by HR partners | Résumé review averages 7 days or less (today 9.2).

Review the dashboard monthly with each administration. | HR Director | Share of hires within 90 days, tracked against the 36.5% baseline.

Check open jobs weekly once they pass 60 days since posting. | HR Recruitment Lead | No open job passes 90 days without a plan.

2. IT and data-quality requests

- Replace free-text status fields with fixed drop-down lists. Case_Status had 8 spellings for 5 statuses, and Offer_Status had 5 spellings for 3 values.

- Trim extra spaces when Division is saved (19 cases had a trailing space).

- Block duplicate records with a unique key on Activity_ID (22 exact duplicate rows were found).

- Add a date check so a step can't be completed before it is assigned (8 records broke this rule).

- Use one standard name per hiring step and per owner. Activity_Label and Responsible_Party are typed in many different ways.

- Provide a short data dictionary, especially for Exception_Code and Phase.

- Add a target for how long a job posting stays open. Today it has none, and postings usually stay open about 17 days.

3. Methods, assumptions and limits

How I measured it

- Unit of analysis: each completed hire, meaning an offer with an onboarding completion date (271 hires).

- Days to fill = onboarding completion date minus the earliest posting date for that job. Reposting a job does not restart the clock.

- Met target = fewer than 90 days (exactly 90 counts as a miss, since the goal says "fewer than").

- Time per hiring step = completed date minus assigned date, so waiting time counts. The 8 impossible negative values were blanked, unfinished steps were left out, and steps before posting were excluded.

- Selection path = whether the job had a phone screen step, a technical assessment step, both, or neither.

Assumptions

- File snapshot date is 31 Oct 2026. The 17 accepted offers without an onboarding date are treated as still in progress, not as misses.

- Different spellings of the same status (for example "Hired" and "Closed-Hired") mean the same thing.

- Jobs that are still open, cancelled, or not yet posted are not part of the 90-day measure.

Sources of uncertainty

- The comparisons show association, not cause. Harder or more senior roles may use more rounds and take longer anyway.

- Hiring steps are recorded once per job, so for jobs with several hires, step times mostly reflect the first hire.

Questions I would confirm with HR and IT

1. Does "Hired" mean the same as "Closed - Hired"?

2. Should the 90-day clock stop at onboarding completion or at the employee's start date?

3. Who decides to add a phone screen or a technical assessment, and are any required for certain job types?

4. What do the Exception_Code values mean, and do they pause the clock?

5. For reposted jobs, should accountability start at the first or the latest posting?

Tools and how to refresh

- Microsoft Excel with Power Query: every cleaning step is recorded in HR_Cleaning.xlsx, along with a DQ_Log of each check. The original CSV files were never edited.

- Tableau Desktop: three separate data sources (hires, stage activities and the original Process Standards file) are blended on Stage Name, and filters work across sources.

- To refresh: replace the CSV files in the Data folder with new exports using the same names, click Data > Refresh All in Excel, re-save hires.csv and stage_activities.csv, and refresh the Tableau extract. For a recurring report, the workbook could be published to Tableau Server with a scheduled refresh, and the Excel steps could later be rebuilt in Tableau Prep, so the whole process runs automatically.

AI use

I used Claude (Anthropic) as a guide while cleaning data in Power Query and Tableau, and to help polish the wording of this note and the executive brief. I did all the data cleaning, calculations and dashboard building myself, checked every number against my own Excel and Tableau results, and edited the conclusions.